



Success not only depends upon teamwork but it is a conglomerate of various functions and tasks. There are three important triangular points – Ideas, Success and Goals

Elvis's sudden surge in popularity in the 1950s, used the opportunity to sell anti-Elvis material! The manager in question, Colonel Tom Parker, was an unsuccessful travelling grifter before he became the star's manager. Despite being poorly educated, Parker had the wily drive for success that meant he could capitalise on any situation he found himself in and came out on top. By modern standards, his Entrepreneurial Metacognitive abilities meant he could make the best of the situation to come out financially on top.

## THINKING RIGHT

While writing for Ness Labs, an online think tank, Anne Laure Le Cunff muses on an idea from Albert Einstein. All of science is nothing more than the refinement of everyday thinking. Why is it that a skill as important as thinking is not a key focus in traditional schools? Why don't we have classes on decision-



Le Cunff suggests a refinement to everyday thinking through which one can develop their entrepreneurial metacognitive abilities

making, cognitive biases, and mental models? Le Cunff breaks down better thinking into three points though which one can develop their entrepreneurial metacognitive abilities, paraphrased here:

1. Logical fallacies and linear thinking should be avoided. Second-level thinking helps us to consider any ramifications that stem from decisions yet to be made. Investor Howard Marks states that "First-level thinking is simplistic and superficial, and just about everyone can do it. All the first-level thinker needs is an opinion about the future. Second-level thinking is deep, complex and convoluted."
2. Use mental models. These constitute frameworks that offer representations of how things operate. Mental models work best in context, or in combination with one another.
3. Emotional agility is important. Don't dismiss the influence our emotions can have on our decision-making process. Emotional agility teaches us to think despite negative impacts on our cognitive ability such as fear or anxiety.

## THINK YOURSELF INTO THE PART

The amount of focus put on metacognitive thinking as a means to increase productivity in education, science and philosophy means it is foolish not to consider it for other applications. A marketer needs to understand how marketing people think in order to successfully engage them. Using an earlier example, Colonel Tom Parker didn't get bogged down thinking about how he could get people who weren't fans to like Elvis, instead he gave them

a way to indulge in their biases without doing the hard job of converting their thinking to his own. This is what the journal of business venturing describes as an "entrepreneurial mindset". A study conducted by Per Davidson from the Jönköping International business school, Sweden, found that students given metacognitive treatments as a learning aid gained strong entrepreneurial expertise faster than those who were not. Other studies have found that close interactions with mentor entrepreneurs do not necessarily help people become 'business savvy'. What we do know is that helping people understand their own thought processes can actually achieve that goal faster. In essence, teaching people HOW to think is a lot better at developing new entrepreneurs than teaching them WHAT to think by giving them



Conscious thoughtfulness can lead to an entrepreneurial mindset which equips an entrepreneur for eight core critical decision-making tasks as shown here

examples of past success stories. And it's not just helpful for entrepreneurs, such thinking can benefit us all for all difficult tasks we take on in life. We certainly hope this article has challenged you to think better, so remember to write in and offer us feedback and let us know if we set off a few cartoon light bulbs above your heads!

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